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Edition No.: 104

 Housing Recovery and
Reconstruction Platform
BULLETIN
17 June 2019



Retrofitted house in Virkot village, Tamakoshi RM, Dolakha. The retrofitting has been carried out by NSET under the Baliyo Ghar programme. The house is one storey plus attic, stone and mud mortar masonry structure. GI wire mesh has been used on the wall internally and externally and the walls have been plastered internally and the plastering externally is underway. The home owner covered the cost of 200,000 NPRs worth of construction materials, NSET provided a top up of 25,000 NPRs as well as covering the labour costs (25 days of 6 masons paid 800 NPRs / day). The photo on the left shows masons gathered at the house during a training on retrofitting.

Featured Technical Staff Person



*Nabin Kumar Yadav
Engineer, Umakunda RM-1, Gumdel, Ramechhap*

This month's featured technical staff person is Nabin Kumar Yadav. Nabin is from Siraha Municipality, Siraha and has been working in Ramechhap for 11 months. The experience has been challenging because the culture, geography, and language are different. He was deployed just a few months after completing his engineering degree and there are no other technical staff in the ward. Having received no training prior to deployment, many of the forms were returned due to mistakes he had made.

Nabin shares how he has progressed and improved in the role. He also used to be a shy, introverted person but his experience working on the reconstruction has made him more outgoing and confident interacting with people.

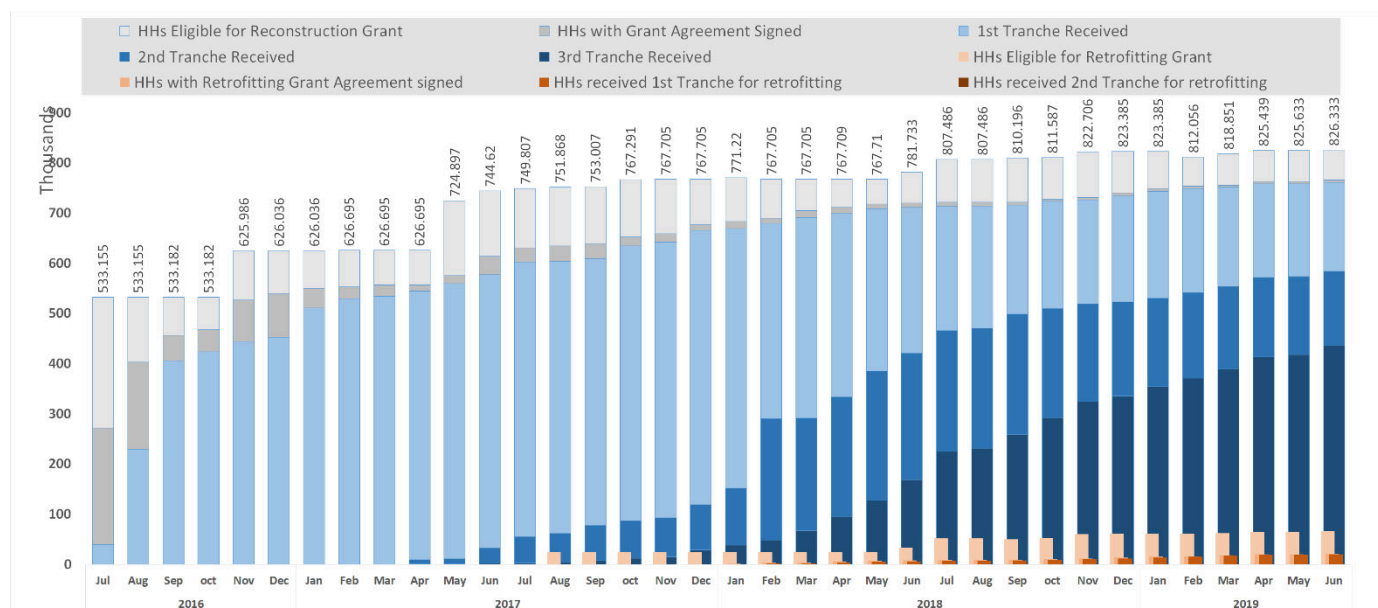
Highlights

- [NRA request for Partner Organisation progress data on projects providing reconstruction support to vulnerable households](#). The template for sharing the data is available [here](#) and the deadline for data submission is 28 June.
 - Meeting to Review NRA GESI Section Draft Work Plan for Potential Engagement with the National DRRM Strategic Plan 2018-30, 21 June. For more information please contact Archana Tamang, NRA GESI Advisor, archana.tamang@gmail.com.
 - In Sindhuli, there is conflict between central and local government regarding right of way for the BP highway. The central government has set 25m from the highway, but the local government has set 15m from the highway and has approved houses for construction.
 - Case study on issues with quality of interlocking blocks, Madhya Nepal Municipality, Lamjung
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National Updates

NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 17 June:

Reconstruction Grant	15 April	13 May	17 June
Total No. Eligible HHs	824,452	825,633	826,333
HHs Enrolled	761,445	763,598	766,316
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	756,214	759,138	761,542
HHs Applied for 2 nd Tranche	578,835	585,529	598,295
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	564,820	573,974	584,516
Non-compliant at 2 nd Tranche	4,326	4,405	4,287
HHs Applied for 3 rd Tranche	422,951	429,951	458,715
HHs Received 3 rd Tranche	403,561	418,417	436,272
Non-compliant at 3 rd Tranche	2,363	2,355	2,222
Houses Completed	382,112	386,527	417,395
HHs with Completion Certificate	8,390	9,008	16,027
Retrofit Grant	15 April	13 May	17 June
Total No. Eligible HHs	63,693	65,977	66,664
HHs Enrolled	20,106	20,291	21,587
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	19,170	19,528	20,877
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	27	41	41



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 17 June 2019.

HRRP4 Consultation Meeting, 4 June 2019: HRRP and CRS met with the NRA CEO, Executive Committee Members, GMALI CLPIU, Building CLPIU, EHRP Deputy Project Director, and the NRA NGO Coordination Section. The HRRP4 project proposal was presented, including strategic objectives, priorities, organisational structure, and budget needs. Following the presentation, those present provided feedback on the proposal. It was recommended that HRRP4 should focus on documenting reconstruction lessons learned, best practices from POs perspectives, focused research on reconstruction issues, urban housing reconstruction, retrofitting, vulnerable household support, tracking tranche duplication, municipal empowerment, and the digitisation of PO project completion reports.

Technical Sharing Session on NSET's Building Code Implementation Programme Nepal (BCIPN), 12 June: this session was organised as an opportunity for HRRP staff to learn about the BCIPN programme and to understand and discuss how coordination efforts can be linked with long term impact. More information about the BCIPN programme is available on the NSET website <http://nset.org.np/bcipnwebsite/>. A technical session for partners on BCIPN is planned and more details will be shared soon.

Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG) Update: the VSWG has been supporting the NRA with the preparation of a 'vulnerable support handbook'. The VSWG members have held several working sessions to draft the handbook. Following several rounds of review with Dr. Chandra Shrestha, NRA Executive Member, the draft was revised and submitted to the NRA for discussion and to be approved by the NRA executive committee. The purpose of the handbook is to provide a complete package of information to all reconstruction actors on support for vulnerable households. The handbook is expected to be the standard operating guidelines for support to vulnerable households and to enhance understanding on the standards for support to vulnerable households and how to apply them.

Consultation Meeting on Community Based Disaster Risk Management (CBDRM) Platform, 14 June: this consultation meeting was organised by the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration (MoFAGA) to share the findings and recommendations from a study on the role of the MoFAGA led Community Based Disaster Risk Management (CBDRM) Platform in longer-term engagement with local, provincial, and federal government. The meeting provided partners with the opportunity to provide input, feedback, and recommendations based on the study findings. The presentation of the study was followed by a group work session where participants worked on key points of relevancy and effectiveness of platform and a way forward drawn out from the recommendations. For further information, please contact Neelam Parajuli, Programme Officer CBDRM Platform Neelam.parajuli@ifrc.org and the MoFAGA Environment and DRM Section cdms.mofaga@gmail.com.

South Asia Conference on the Role of Local Government in Disaster Management, Energy, and Climate Action, 10-11 June: mayors, elected local representatives and officials, national and international associations of local governments, development partners, and Civil Society Organizations (CSOs) gathered for this event which included a keynote presentation from the NRA CEO on 'Nepal Post Earthquake Reconstruction towards Sustainable Resilience' as well as plenary discussions on various topics. During the conference, [the Kathmandu Action Agenda](#) was adopted recognising the work done by central and local governments, development actors, CSOs, and other stakeholders in localising the Global Agenda in South Asia Countries. The document particularly highlights the progress made by the Government of Nepal on local government reform and the post-earthquake reconstruction and recovery effort. Local authorities, academic institutions, professional organisations, and national government officials from India, China, Pakistan, Bangladesh, Indonesia, Sri Lanka, and Nepal participated in the event.

District & Municipal Updates

Training of Trainers on Earthquake Resistant Timber Frame House Construction, Swiss Contact, Sindhuli, 16-18

May: the training was carried out under the Swiss Contact Skills for Safe Reconstruction Project (SSRP) and was provided to technical staff working in reconstruction. Twenty technical staff participated in the training. SSRP also conducted a 7-day skill upgrading training on earthquake resilient timber frame building construction techniques to 120 carpenters working in the housing reconstruction.

Seven day Training of Trainers on Earthquake Resistant Building Construction, Okhaldhunga, 19-25 May: this training was jointly organised by Building CLPIU and DLPIU and HRRP and NSET provided technical support. 34 Engineers from Solukhumbu, Okhaldhunga, and Khotang attended the training.

HRRP District Coordination Meetings, 9 May – 13 June 2019: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Makwanpur (15 May), Rasuwa (18 May), Gorkha (20 May), Lalitpur (21 May), Dhading (22 May), Dolakha (22 & 28 May), Sindhupalchok (23 May), Nuwakot (23 May), Kathmandu (2 June), Kavrepalanchok (3

June), Tanahun (5 June), Okhaldhunga (7 June), Lamjung (9 June), and Sindhuli (11 June). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Makwanpur**, there are households who have not progressed beyond the first or second tranche and it was decided to coordinate with all municipalities to work collectively on supporting these households. It was reported that many people have applied to be included in the list of households eligible for financial assistance through resurvey and reverification. The relevant ward offices were requested to mobilise the technical staff to support completion of the resurvey and reverification process on time. The ward offices were also requested to report if any technical staff are found to be absent from their working area or are not working properly.
- In **Rasuwa**, the District Reconstruction Committee decided to coordinate with municipalities and wards to settle issues between host communities and the 14 displaced households in Uttargaya Rural Municipality where land was purchased with NRA land grant under the relocation policy. In addition, the committee decided to request central NRA to purchase land for 24 displaced households in Rasuwa in other places as they had purchased land under high transmission line in Shantibazar, Nuwakot.
- In **Gorkha**, the meeting decided that local representatives, in coordination with Partner Organisations (POs), will identify households who have taken the first tranche but not started reconstruction, households who received the second tranche and have not progressed any further, and households who received the third tranche and have not completed the house. The meeting also decided to request CLPIU to provide budget for land for landless households and mentioned that any landless people waiting to be on the eligibility list for government financial assistance are placed on the list.
- In **Lalitpur**, Solve Nepal with support from CECI Nepal has completed its 'Livelihood Promotion for Earthquake Affected Population in Nepal' programme where 1,135 households have directly benefitted through agriculture and livestock support and DRR capacity building activities and training. Love Green Nepal reported that 90% of reconstruction has been completed in Saraswoti Adharbhat School in ward 2, Lele, Godawari Municipality. RICOD has provided additional top up support of 50,000 NPRs to 43 marginalised and earthquake affected households and material support to construct latrines to 2 households.
- In **Dhading**, the meeting focused on households who have received the second and third tranches but are still living in hazard risk areas. The committee decided to request NRA to provide guidelines and procedures for the purchase of land for these households. There was also discussion on cases of households receiving tranches without constructing new houses in Tripurasundari Rural Municipality.
- In **Dolakha**, the GMAI Chief recommended creating a mobile application like the one in Rasuwa to facilitate households in tracking their tranche status and reconstruction progress. They also requested POs to document best practices and case studies to share during coordination meetings. It was reported that a school reconstruction agreement has been signed between the governments of Nepal, India, and China but the reconstruction of some school buildings has not started yet. Ninety-three out of ninety-nine households whose house was constructed by the Young Living Foundation in Baitheshor Rural Municipality have also received financial assistance from the government. The rural municipality have been requested to work to recovery the first tranche. Municipalities were requested to coordinate with the wards to start completion certificate distribution to the households.
- In **Sindhupalchok**, the meeting focused on reconstruction progress, issues regarding resurvey and reverification, and vulnerable and landless issues in the district. The provision of providing 200,000 NPRs to the landless beneficiaries and coordinating with the ward offices to verify the vulnerable list and seeking support from partner organisations for the reconstruction of houses of some vulnerable were discussed during the meeting.
- In **Nuwakot**, it was reported that tranche of 40 beneficiaries under category 3 hazard risk area had been stopped since they had safer houses in other places. The meeting decided that if those houses were built after the earthquake 2015 and meet the building code standard, further tranches will be released. It was

mentioned that a geological survey team from NRA will resurvey the hazard risk areas where displaced beneficiaries under category 3 have reconstructed their houses and take further action accordingly. Further, the meeting decided to inform and circulate a letter to ward offices regarding the demolition of damaged houses.

- In **Kathmandu**, the district reconstruction committee requested to identify the multiple beneficiaries and beneficiaries who have not been able to start reconstruction due to land issues and submit to District Coordination Committee (DCC). DLPIU Education agreed to provide a list of the municipalities where land is required for school reconstruction to the DCC. GMALI will coordinate with the banks and conduct a meeting to resolve the banking issues. The meeting emphasised the need to conduct joint monitoring visits for other sectors, not just private housing, to understand and resolve the issues at field level. The committee decided to coordinate with municipal and ward representatives to bring non-enrolled household into the housing reconstruction programme or else to remove them from the list.
- In **Kavrepalanchok**, it was agreed that HRRP will collect the list of all partners who have signed the tripartite agreement with NRA to conduct their activities in Kavrepalanchok district and identify those not working in the district. GMALI/DLPIU will request NRA to investigate POs not working in the district.
- In **Tanahun**, the committee decided to mobilise additional technical staff in the field to complete the resurvey and reverification within the given time. The municipalities and wards are responsible for the effective mobilisation of technical staff in the field during the survey. A separate committee will be formed at the district level to monitor the activities and accomplish the survey on time. DLPIU Building will conduct a one day orientation programme to newly deployed technical staff on 7 June.
- In **Okhaldhunga**, the discussion was focused on completing the resurvey and reverification process within the deadline. It also decided to coordinate with concerned stakeholders to resolve the issues related to tranche payments to households. To speed up reconstruction, concerned stakeholders will be requested for workplan of activities related to PA digitisation of inspection forms, inspection of houses that are completed for distribution of completion certificate, and integrated settlement.
- In **Lamjung**, the committee decided to coordinate with all municipalities and wards to enroll all eligible households who have not yet done so. DLPIU GMaLI, DLPIU Building, and HRRP agreed to start the process of getting the tranche back from the households who have received the grant from the government and POs and to collect information on houses constructed by Gorkha Welfare. The meeting also decided to coordinate with municipalities and wards to start relocation of eligible displaced households listed by NRA and to gather information of their status.
- In **Sindhuli**, the discussion mainly focused on issues related to landless families living on Ailani land (Government owned land) where they have been living for many generations. The meeting provided a solution for the landless families living on ailani land in Dudhouli Municipality based on NRA policy. The meeting also decided to coordinate with concerned stakeholders to discuss and resolve any issues related to reconstruction to expedite the reconstruction process.

HRRP Municipal / Ward Level Coordination Meetings, 9 May – 13 June 2019: during this period municipal / ward level coordination meetings took place in municipalities / wards across all of the 14 districts most affected by the earthquake as well as in Lamjung, Tanahun, Syangja, Kaski, and Solukhumbu. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Bhaktapur**, meetings took place in **Wards 2, 3, and 4, Bhaktapur Municipality (23 May 2019), Ward 7, Madhyapur Thimi Municipality (6 June 2019) and Ward 5, Changunarayan Municipality (7 June 2019)**: the main reconstruction issues are lack of land ownership certificates, people living on small parcels of land, land ownership issues among multiple households, dispute among siblings regarding property access, land issues among family members and neighbors, and households living on government owned land which has restricted them from getting building drawing. Many of the families have houses in other places but are continuing to live in the earthquake damaged houses. Some families do not have enough money to

demolish their earthquake damaged houses. The government grant is a much smaller percentage of the total cost of construction in urban areas than in rural areas which is a factor in some families not being interested in the reconstruction process. Some of the households are economically poor and vulnerable and are not able to start reconstruction. In **Wards 2, 3, 4, of Bhaktapur Municipality**, ward offices reported to have received less housing reconstruction applications in the current fiscal year 2018/2019. A huge gap was reported between households receiving second and third tranche. Ward Offices have decided to encourage households to complete reconstruction on time or request them to switch from full reconstruction to retrofitting beneficiaries. In **Ward 7, Madhyapur Thimi Municipality**, the Municipal office has not approved building drawings for houses in low land and protected green belt areas. There are about 65 households that have not done the Partnership Agreement (PA). Ward office has decided to issue public notice and to mobilise ward members to inform these households of the deadline to do PA and request them to start reconstruction, otherwise to remove them from the beneficiary list. In **Ward 5, Changunarayan Municipality**, some houses in the ward are non-compliant and require further correction to be eligible to receive subsequent tranches. Ward office has decided to issue public notice to inform 264 households that have not yet done the PA with the Government.

- In **Ward 2, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Dhading** various cases of “fake beneficiaries” have been reported. There are beneficiaries who have received all three tranches without constructing new houses. They received the tranche showing their old houses or other’s houses. Similarly, there are beneficiaries who have received tranches just by repairing their old houses and showing non-compliant houses. There are also beneficiaries whose houses were built by other organizations, but they have received tranches from the Government too.
- In **Dolakha**, meetings took place in **Sailung Rural Municipality (9 May 2019), Tamakoshi Rural Municipality (20 May 2019), Baiteshwor Rural Municipality (23 May 2019), Ward 1, Bhimeshor Municipality (29 May 2019), Wards 4 & 5, Jiri Municipality (30 May 2019), Dolakha**: One of the common issues in these municipalities is households taking all three tranches without completing the house reconstruction. It was noted that many households that were left out have been included in the resurvey and reverification in most of the wards. Meetings conducted in these municipalities decided to start the inspection of houses of beneficiaries who have received third tranche to process for completion certificate distribution. Based on the caseloads final inspection will be conducted with technical support from DLPIU Building in close coordination with ward offices. In the meeting, it was decided that if any households have not completed reconstruction, PA number and the reasons for not completing must be sent to DLPIU Building. It was mentioned that only after the first and second inspection digitisation is completed, third inspection data needs to be checked and uploaded in the EHRP portal. Technical staff were requested to resolve issues related to duplication, date, and photos. For the remaining PA digitisation, DLPIU Building to provide the list of missing records. In **Ward 1, Bhimeshor Municipality**, discussion was on reconstruction and development of an integrated settlement for vulnerable households living in temporary shelters in Panipokhari village, management of water drainage system in the settlement. In **Jiri Municipality**, there is an issue with recently married couples, separated family in 2073-2074 BS been registered in resurvey and reverification. A lack of reconstruction data at wards, biasness in processing the files, absence of engineers in the field and delay in payment by the banks were also discussed during the meeting.
- In **Kathmandu**, meetings took place in **Gokarneshwor Municipality (29 May 2019) and Shankarapur Municipality (29 May 2019)**: meetings were conducted in **Ward 3** and at **municipal level of Gokarneshwor Municipality**. The main issue discussed was the gap in reconstruction rate caused due to households in beneficiaries list not signing the PA. Kathmandu GMaLI has sent the list of such beneficiaries that are yet to sign PA to all the Municipalities and has requested the Municipal representatives to coordinate with wards to identify the reasons. Further, ward representatives have been requested to encourage the beneficiaries to start reconstruction or remove them from the list if not willing to reconstruct. GMaLI has also requested Municipal representatives to verify the list of vulnerable beneficiaries. Ward representatives are also

requested to add or remove the beneficiaries from the list if they have completed reconstruction or received support from any other source. On the other hand, they could also add if genuine vulnerable households are found to be missing in the list. Municipal representatives have also been requested to identify any cultural heritage sites and send to GMaLI. In **ward 3**, especially there are lands which are under Government reserve rights and have affected reconstruction process. In **Shankarapur Municipality** the main discussion was on beneficiaries supported by LWF. The PA number and the copy of the agreement done by these beneficiaries are being collected and will be sent to GMaLI for further process. Wards 6 and 7 have been declared as heritage sites and Municipality has provided additional support of 100,000 NPRs for those beneficiaries who have reconstructed houses as per vernacular architect, preserving the traditional culture of the area.

- In **Kavrepalanchok**, under the direction of CLPIU/Building, DLPIU/Building Kavre formed a Ghumti Toli conducted Municipal level visits and meetings in all the **13 Rural Municipalities and Municipalities** of the district from **20 -23 May 2019** and **28 – 29 May 2019**. The meetings mainly discussed on caseloads, third inspection and the CS Entry with the technical persons in each Municipalities. Meetings made few decisions such as (1) completion of CS Entry of caseloads by mid-June 2019, (2) completion of the CS Entry of beneficiaries who have received tranches, (3) completion of the backlogs and issues in CS Entry, and (4) completion of third inspection and CS Entry of beneficiaries who have received third tranche by 60-75% within mid-July 2019.
- In **Lalitpur** ward level meeting was conducted in **Ward 8, Mahalaxmi Municipality (16 May 2019)**, main reconstruction issues are beneficiaries living in Government owned land, cases of multiple beneficiaries living on small parcels of land, and eccentric footings. Himalayan Dana Foundation supported to rebuild houses of some poor and vulnerable people right after the earthquake. Ward office and the related banks were requested to coordinate with beneficiaries supported by the foundation to return the first tranche taken from the Government to avoid duplication of grant.
- In **Ramechhap**, meetings took place in **Khadadevi Rural Municipality (12 May 2019)**, **Doramba Rural Municipality (13 May 2019)**, **Sunapati Rural Municipality (15 May 2019)**, **Ward 4, Gokuganga Rural Municipality (4 June 2019)**, **Umakanda Rural Municipality (6 June 2019)**: the common issue reported is delay in result of retrofitting creating confusion amongst beneficiaries as many retrofitting beneficiaries had applied to become full reconstruction beneficiaries. It was reported that local representatives are facing a challenge in moving the beneficiaries to their new house. Many of them are using the old house as kitchen as the space in new house is not enough for them. Beneficiaries are also not willing to demolish the old damaged house due to emotional attachment with the house. It was also noted that many people have applied through grievance process to have their names in beneficiary list. However, not all of these are earthquake affected. In **Ward 4, Gokuganga RM** it was reported that out of the 350 grievances filed 100 were fake. So, Ward Chief assured to carefully check this and recommend only the genuine households affected by the earthquake. Municipal Chiefs also requested Engineers to be cautious during the resurvey and reverification process and avoid getting under beneficiaries' pressure. In **Khadadevi RM**, Ward Chiefs expressed concerns regarding the timeline of resurvey and reverification as it seemed difficult to complete the survey by 15 June 2019 with only two engineers deployed in the ward. In **Doramba RM**, the Municipal Chief requested all the Ward Chiefs to be engaged during resurvey and reverification process in verifying and recommending the houses for government housing grant and not to miss out the genuine earthquake affected households. Ward Chiefs requested to include the households recommended by ward level grievance management committee, otherwise they would have difficulty facing the public. In **Sunapati RM** there are some retrofit beneficiaries who want to switch to full reconstruction beneficiaries so, they have not signed the PA. Ward Chiefs suggested that the municipality take action against those who do not want to move and demolish the house. In **Umakanda RM**, reconstruction is going on well. However, 30% of the houses reconstructed immediately after the earthquake, that is before the deployment of engineers by NRA have not received the subsequent tranches. Municipal representatives were requested to coordinate

with ward level to collect reliable data on the houses built immediately after the earthquake and submit to NRA for further process.

- In **Makwanpur**, Municipal/Ward level meetings took place in **Kailash Rural Municipality (20 May 2019)** and **Ward 7, Thaha Municipality (21 May 2019)**: in **Kailash RM** reconstruction is rapidly progressing, but no progress has been made with retrofitting. Beneficiaries are either not interested or not been convinced to do retrofitting in terms of cost, availability of materials and man power. Municipal reported of receiving not many grievances from the wards. It was reported that in **Ward 7, Thaha Municipality** 85% of reconstruction has been completed but not much progress has been made with final inspection and CS entry processes. Regarding retrofitting, the meeting decided to conduct an orientation with two houses in ward 7 as demo for retrofitting.
- In **Nuwkakat**, meetings were conducted in **Wards 8 & 9, Belkotgadhi Municipality (4 June 2019)**, the key reconstruction issue in these wards is retrofitting. Beneficiaries in retrofitting list who applied to be switched to full reconstruction beneficiaries are still waiting for the result from NRA. In ward 8, decision is still pending of 28 houses with 9" x 12" column built immediately after the earthquake. DSE has assured to conduct structural analysis of these houses keeping as a priority. The field engineers were requested to speed up third/final inspection for the distribution of completion certificate. Ward Chiefs also agreed to support the engineers to do final inspection and completion certificate handover program around August 2019.
- In **Sindhuli**, meetings took place in **Sunkoshi Rural Municipality (15 May 2019)** and **Ward 5, Ghyanglekh Rural Municipality (29 May 2019)**: in **Sunkoshi RM**, some of the common issues and challenges raised by Ward Chiefs were missing out of the real earthquake beneficiaries, houses constructed immediately after the earthquake, delay in decision of beneficiaries who have applied to become full reconstruction beneficiaries rather than retrofitting beneficiaries. Ward Chiefs reported that house owners have been expanding their houses in vertical direction after receiving third tranche. They said it would be difficult to complete the resurvey and reverification process in allocated time due to high number of grievances and the smaller number of engineers assigned or the survey. There is conflict between central and local Government regarding right of way with BP highway. The national has set 25 m from highway whereas the local government has 15 m and has approved the houses for construction. In **Ward 5, Ghyanglekh RM**, it was discussed that resurvey and reverification process could not start due to limited human resources who have been involved for the survey in other wards. Newly joined technical persons were oriented on the process of conversion of beneficiaries from retrofitting to full reconstruction beneficiaries along with sharing of hollow concrete block manual. Ward Chief was requested to revise the vulnerable group list and send it to Municipal office for verification.
- In **Lamjung**, meetings took place in **Rainas Municipality (26 May 2019)**, **Sundar Bazar Municipality (26 May 2019)** and **Madhya Nepal Municipality (28 May 2019)**: DLPIU GMaLI and DLPIU Building updated on the reconstruction progress of each Municipalities, discussed on the challenges faced by Municipal and Wards and way forward to speed up reconstruction. The main issue in these Municipalities is the non-compliant houses constructed immediately after the earthquake. Many beneficiaries have not started construction even the have received first tranche. The meetings decided to request District Facilitation committee and NRA to make decision regarding those non-compliant issues and to coordinate with banks to make the grant transfer process to the beneficiaries easy and fast.
- In **Kaski**, meeting was conducted in **Annapurna Rural Municipality (5 June 2019)**, mainly issues and challenges related to houses constructed immediately after the earthquake, delay in result of conversion from retrofitting to full reconstruction beneficiaries and houses built in ailani land (Government land). There is also lack of technical manpower for carrying out retrofitting. It was reported that houses built before the deployment of technical persons are non-compliant so, the meeting decided to form a monitoring team to facilitate these houses in getting further tranches by encouraging the beneficiaries to apply correction measures as required.

- In **Syangja**, meeting was conducted in **Putali Bazar Municipality (6 June 2019)**, which discussed on effective mobilisation of technical staff in the field for resurvey and reverification to complete the survey on time. The meeting decided to request District Facilitation committee and NRA to make decision regarding the non-compliant houses constructed after the earthquake, before the deployment of technical persons in the field. The Municipal has decided to appoint a focal person to coordinate with district, wards and the technical persons.
- In **Solukhumbu**, ward meeting was conducted in **Dudhkoshi Rural Municipality (11 June 2019)**, it was reported that due to lack of trained masons it has been difficult to complete the reconstruction. Ward representatives requested for mason training in the ward. Ward Chief said the resurvey and reverification is going smoothly in the ward and will be completed within the deadline. Regarding the non-compliant houses constructed immediately after the earthquake, before the deployment of NRA technical staffs, Ward Chief assured to encourage those beneficiaries to apply correction measures to get further tranches.

HRRP District Coordination Team, Bhaktapur and Lalitpur, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 10, Suryabinayak Municipality, Bhaktapur: two storey, eight room, brick and cement mortar masonry house which is under construction. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and third tranche is in process.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 6, Nagarjun Municipality, Kathmandu: one and a half storey prefab structure. The house is considered unsafe due to the RC slab used for the first storey. The home owner has received the first tranche of the Government housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team, Kavrepalanchok and Sindhupalchok, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 5, Khanikhola Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: two storey hybrid structure. The home owner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant. The home owner is in the process to shift to the new house.

HRRP District Coordination Team, Dhading and Gorkha, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward 2, Tripurasundari Rural Municipality, Dhading: single storey, three room, brick and cement mortar masonry house with RCC bands and flexible roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team, Dolakha, Ramechhap, and Sindhuli Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward 4, Sailung Rural Municipality, Dolakha: demo retrofit house under progress, two room stone and mud mortar masonry. The home owner is a retrofit beneficiary and has received the first tranche of the GoN housing retrofit grant. Technical support is provided by NSET Baliyo Ghar where 5 masons and one head mason are being trained.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Chitwan, and Nawalparasi, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 12, Hetauda Sub Metropolitan City, Makwanpur: single storey, two room, load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry house with flexible roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction was 800,000 NPRs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot and Rasuwa, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 3, Bidur Municipality, Nuwakot: single storey, two room, load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry structure with flexible roof. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski and Syangja, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June 2019



Ward No. 5, Madhya Nepal Municipality, Lamjung: single storey, five room house constructed with interlocking bricks. The floor area is less than 1000 sq.ft. and the building size is 25 x 18 feet. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction was 550,000 NPRs.

HRRP District Coordination Team Solukhumbu, Okhaldhunga, and Khotang, Monthly Report, 9 May – 13 June



Ward 6, Dudhkoshi Rural Municipality, Solukhumbu: single storey, two room, stone and mud mortar masonry house with timber plank walls and timber columns, but without horizontal bands. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. This is a common type of house in the area.

Case Studies

Featured technical staff person, Nabin Kumar Yadav: Nabin is from from Bariyarpatti, Siraha Municipality-5, Siraha and has been working in Umakunda RM-1, Gumdel, Ramechhap for the past 11 months. The experience has been challenging because the culture, geography, and language are different. He was deployed just a few months after completing his engineering degree and there are no other technical staff in the ward. Having received no training prior to deployment, many of the forms were returned due to mistakes he had made. On some occasions he would come across households who used threatening and aggressive language towards him which was very difficult, and the Ward Chiefs were not present to assist him. Nabin feels that things became easier for him when he began living in the house of a local hotelier and political activist called Jhappar Karki. Jhappar helped him adapt to the local environment and to deal with the threatening and aggressive behaviour that he sometimes faced.

Gumdel is the most rural area of Ramechhap, with topography that is characterised by very high hills and small, scattered settlements. Due to the remoteness of the area, the turnover in inspection engineers working in Gumdel has been high. As Nabin was raised in the Terai he was not accustomed to walking long distances. Things became easier for Nabin when a sub-engineer was deployed to Gumdel three months after he began working there. This meant that they could divide the working area making it easier to visit more households.

There had been a lot of non-compliant houses built in the area because initially the presence of engineers was limited. Many of these households have now carried out the required corrections but Nabin has found that it has been difficult to convince others to apply corrections because of the high cost of materials. There are also a lot of stone and mud mortar masonry houses which are more than one storey. These houses were built immediately after the earthquake and do not have horizontal bands making it effectively impossible to apply corrections. Nabin has collected data on these houses which was submitted to the DLPIU, but the issue has yet to be resolved. As it is one of the most common issues that arises during inspection visits, Nabin hopes that it can be addressed by the NRA soon.

Despite the challenging start, Nabin is now finding his work on the reconstruction very positive. Before starting this work, he a shy, introverted person but he is now more outgoing and confident interacting with people. He is happy to see the increased awareness of safer reconstruction practices and that people are applying these practices even in the most remote places where construction costs are higher.

Issues with Quality of Interlocking Blocks, Madhya Nepal Municipality, Lamjung: during recent field visits to Madhya Nepal municipality, the HRRP District Coordination Team were concerned to see some houses have been built using low quality interlocking blocks. There are significant cracks in the walls of newly built houses and the blocks did not withstand a drop test (5 samples were dropped and all broke into several pieces). The team asked house owners why they had chosen to use these poor quality materials and they shared that they had no knowledge of how to check the quality of materials. The team also asked the technical staff working in the area why they had not provided advice to households on material quality. The technical staff shared that their role is to ensure minimum compliance for the whole building, but they have no information on quality of materials. The houses that the team saw during the visit have only been approved for the second tranche, but not the third. Based on this experience, the HRRP District Coordination Team have recommended that investment is required in training and business support for construction material producers and vendors.



Interlocking block broken into several pieces after drop test.

Draupadi Thapa, Ward no. 10, Chitapol, Suryabinayak Municipality, Bhaktapur: Draupadi is a 71 year old widow (her husband died five years ago). She has been living separately from her four sons and their families for more than twenty years but they all live in the same area. Draupadi and her family made their income from raising livestock and agriculture. Now Draupadi receives an old age pension which she utilises to raise goats for sale. Draupadi's one storey, two room brick and mud mortar masonry house completely collapsed in the earthquake. She was then looked after by her sons and their families but she decided that she wanted to reside in a separate house again like she used to before the earthquake. She signed the partnership agreement with the government and also took a loan of 200,000 NPRs from a local woman's group at an annual interest rate of 17%. She intends to repay the loan by selling goats. Water shortages in the area delayed reconstruction of her house but it is now almost complete and she has applied for the second tranche.



Draupadi Thapa outside her newly built house.

Kuma Maharjan, Thalkhu, Ward No. 6, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu: Kuma is a senior citizen whose house was badly damaged by the earthquake. Since the earthquake he has been living in a temporary shelter with his brother who is also a senior citizen and his daughter who looks after them. Due to their poor economic condition, and his poor physical condition, he had still not been able to demolish his damaged house which meant he could not even consider beginning reconstruction. An orientation and consultation programme was conducted in Dakshinkali Municipality by the GMALI DLPIU as part of the Environment and Social Management plan under the Environment and Social Management Framework. To address the issue raised during the programme held on 31 December 2018 the municipality selected debris management in Thalkhu as their sub-project. The site verification was carried out by the municipality engineer and Environment and Social Development specialist. As per the approved sub-project of ESMP major mitigation measures to be carried out included dismantling damaged houses and management of debris about 300m away (site recommended by the ward office). The budget for demolition and debris management is estimated to be approximately 70,000 NPRs. Mr. Maharjan has received the first tranche of the housing reconstruction grant. Regarding the reconstruction of the house, the ward office has taken the full responsibility of constructing a two room load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry structure within the 300,000 NPRs available through the government's financial assistance for housing reconstruction.



Kuma Maharjan inside his temporary shelter (L) and the outside of his temporary shelter (R).

Requests for Partner Support

NRA Request for Partner Organisation Progress Data on Projects Providing Reconstruction Support to Vulnerable Households: the NRA has written to the 6 Partner Organisations (POs) implementing projects providing support to vulnerable households requesting data on the households' tranche status, type of support the POs are providing, and the PA numbers of the households supported. The template for sharing the data is available [here](#) and the deadline for data submission is 28 June.

Meeting to Review NRA GESI Section Draft Work Plan for Potential Engagement with the National DRRM Strategic Plan 2018-30, 21 June: the work plan has been prepared for the Nepali fiscal year 76/77 and the associated budget has been approved by the NRA. The work plan activities and focus will be discussed during the meeting. The National DRRM policy and strategic plan are available [here](#). For more information please contact Archana Tamang, NRA GESI Advisor, archana.tamang@gmail.com.

HRRP Products

Summary Report on Household Level Data Collected from Partner Organisations: HRRP has supported GMALI CLPIU to collect household level data from POs to identify why some people have not been able to participate in the housing reconstruction process. Data was collected from 9 POs, covering 82,836 households, across 56 municipalities, and 14 districts. This summary report has been prepared based on HRRP analysis of the data collected. This is intended to contribute to identifying appropriate ways to support households to engage with the housing reconstruction process. This process is also intended to support the Case Load Verification (CLOVeR) process which is planned by NRA and the CLPIUs, with support from HRRP, in all earthquake affected districts. The Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG) has submitted two options to the NRA for the CLOVeR exercise; one

option is a household level survey and the other option is to have the inspection engineers collect the data through MIS data disaggregation. The NRA are reviewing both options and will make a decision on how to proceed soon.

Partner Products

[ASF Nepal, Newsletter #27, March & April 2019](#)

Milijuli Nepali, Episode 1122: this is a studio based interview with Manohar Ghimire, NRA spokesperson from December 2018. When asked about the current activities that NRA is working on Manohar Ghimire replied they are focusing on resettlement of the people who are living in landslide prone area and on retrofitting to complete all the activities within the next two years. The programmes also had pre-recorded voices of the people with various questions. The first voice is of a health worker from Kavre who asks if the government is providing low interest loans to help with reconstruction. Mr. Manohar Ghimire replied that government have approved the loan scheme where three lakhs rupee will be provided at low interest over five years. The second voice is of Seti Maya from Makwanpur. She shares that she has filed a grievance for the third time but still has not been listed as eligible for the government's financial assistance for housing reconstruction. The third voice is Umesh Poudel from Khotang who was abroad and could not file a grievance but has now returned and wants to know if he can file a grievance. The last voice is Usha Bhujel from Sinduli who shares that it is unfair to provide only one lakh rupees for retrofitting compared to three lakhs for reconstruction. Mr. Manohar Ghimire answered all the questions and provided positive feedback on how the people will be able to access the financial assistance. He also said that people will get the tranche amount even if they get help from an organisation to support their retrofitting.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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